Five days later, I was at Andrews Air Force Base when the bodies of sixteen Americans murdered in the bombing came home. My diary entry that night:

> Nancy and I met individually all the families of the deceased. We were both in tears. All I could do was grip their hands. I was too choked up to speak. . . . [Later] home to change clothes and off to the White House correspondents dinner. I was supposed to do a routine of jokes, etc. I couldn't change gears that swiftly. So as not to put a damper on the evening . . . I waited till the last and then asked their pardon for not "singing for my supper" because of our sad journey to Andrews AF Base.

There were many, too many, days like that when I was president.

Agonized as all of us were over this tragedy, George Shultz suggested that he go to the Middle East to attempt to breathe new life into the peace process Phil Habib had so ably kept alive for more than a year. Worn out from service above and beyond the call of duty, Habib wanted to resume the retirement from which we had lured him the year before.

Soon after he arrived in the Middle East, George sent me a cable in which he said that he thought all sides in the dispute seemed to be growing anxious to end the killing and destruction; he said he felt a degree of optimism that his mission would succeed.

It did: During two weeks of intensive negotiations, George worked out an agreement under which Israel promised to withdraw from Lebanon simultaneously with Syrian forces, and Lebanon, the second state in the Middle East (after Egypt) to formally recognize the existence of Israel, agreed to the establishment near its southern border of a security zone designed to enhance the protection of northern Israeli settlements.